INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, KANPUR
POST GRADUATE OFFICE

No. (P)/SPGC/IITK/2018-19/
September 30, 2019

MINUTES OF THE 9th MEETING OF THE SENATE POSTGRADUATE COMMITTEE (2018-19)

(Date & Time: September 13, 2019 Friday, 4:00 pm; Venue: QIP Conference Room, Academic Affairs Building)

Members Present: Drs Raghvendra Kukillaya (in place of Dr S Mariappan), I S Dalal, A Das (in place of Dr S Misra), R P Potluri, A Gupta (in place of Dr S Khandekar), M Chaudhary, P Sen, P Kulshreshtha (in place of Dr W Ahmed) S Mitra, G Rajshekhar, D Kumar, A Jain, N Kaistha and Ms Somya Sharma and Shruti Dubey (in place of Vineeth V)

Members Absent: Drs A Singh, R Varman P Munshi, M J Akhtar, S T Roy, D Chakrabarti, A Shukla, R Bhowmik, I S Sen, Mr. U Sagar, Ms. S Sharma and Mr. V hariharan

Item 0 Confirmation of Minutes of the eighth meeting of SPGC (2018-19) held on July 16, 2019.
The minutes were confirmed.

Item 1 Ratification of Decisions Taken / Approvals Given by Chairperson, SPGC
The SPGC ratified the following decisions taken / approvals given by Chairperson, SPGC:

Ratification Items

(a) Theses submission deadline extension

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dep/IDP*	*Due Date*	*Extension till*
p	13100069	Roli Pandey	HSS	30/07/2019	30/08/2019
02	10109067	Pankaj Singh	PHY	07/08/2019	07/09/2019
03	13105165	Divyansh Patel	ME	30/09/2019	31/12/2019
04	11207061	Akhilesh Kumar	CHM	20/08/2019	19/11/2019
05	13109065	Gyana Ranjan Sahoo	PHY	27/08/2019	10/102019
06	14101265	DibakarMahalanabish	AE	12/09/2019	03/10/2019

(b) SOTA deadline extension

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept /IDP*	*Due Date*	*Extension till*
01	17101274	Spandan Bandyopadhyay	AE	11/08/2019	21/08/2019
02	17208264	Sudipta Mukherjee	MTH	02/08/2019	02/11/2019
03	17105283	Vinay K Tripathi	ME	22/07/2019	22/10/2019
04	16204269	Chintu Gurbani	EE	12/07/2019	12/08/2019
05	17123261	Anshita Nayak	ES	06/08/2019	06/11/2019
06	16204267	Baljinder Singh Heera	EE	31/07/2019	31/10/2019
07	16203262	Ashanullah Khan	CE	02/08/2019	02/10/2019*
08	17200266	Madhuparna Nayak	HSS	14/09/2019	14/12/2019
09	17200262	Ayushi Dube	HSS	14/09/2019	14/12/2019
10	17516262	Shivam Shukla	PSE	28/08/2019	28/11/2019
11	17105271	Harisri M Thulasi	ME	22/08/2019	22/11/2019
12	17516262	Shivam Shukla	PSE	28/08/2019	28/11/2019
13	17103261	Aamna Sarfraz	CE	27/08/2019	27/09/2019

* second extension granted as a special case (compassionate grounds)

(c) Leave granted on personal / medical grounds

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*
01	15103035	Saurabh Srivastava	CE	M Tech	2019-20-I; DPGC positive.
02	17106017	Durgesh Shukla	MSE	M Tech	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
03	14100261	Abhishek Kumar	ECO	PhD	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
04	10200062	Gurwinder Kaur	ECO	PhD	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
05	14105291	Shruti Pandey	ME	PhD	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.

06	18105086	Shubham Pachauri	ME	M Tech	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
07	17104035	M S Surender	EE	M Tech	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
08	17111002	Abhishek Valsan	CSE	M Tech	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
09	16114263	Md Ashraf Alam	IME	M Tech	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
10	19107283	Nandini Saraswati	CHM	PhD	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
11	17101023	Gurav Upadhyay	AE	M Tech	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
12	17104049	Rajat Singhal	EE	M Tech	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
13	17103016	Arjun M	CE	M Tech	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
14	18100262	Aditi Saraswat	HSS	PhD	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.
15	15112262	Arun Kr Agarwal	MSP	PhD	2019-20-I; Personal grounds; DPGC positive.

Item 2 Reporting Items

The SPGC took note of the following reporting item

(a) Withdrawal from the PG program

SNo	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept./IDP*	*Program*
01	19105093	RajatShubham	ME	M Tech
02	19109265	Apurbakarmakar	PHY	PhD
03	18112001	Deepshikha	MSP	M Tech
04	18218263	Faisal Ahmad	BSBE	PhD
05	19104006	Akshay Pathak	EE	M Tech
06	18101015	Faraz Ahmad Khan	AE	M Tech
07	18205410	SaurabhPrajapati	ME	MSR
08	19103285	ShubhamNaresh	CE	PhD
09	19123265	TapanHandique	ES	PhD
10	18200272	Ramashray Yadav	HSS	PhD
11	17106025	Kulkarni RuturajRajendra	MSE	M Tech
12	18205019	Arvind Kumar	ME	M Tech
13	19105080	Prakhar Bhatt	ME	M Tech

Item 3 Routine Items Requiring SPGC Approval

SPGC granted approval to following routine items with noted specific observations (if any)

(a) New course approval

The SPGC approved following new courses

SNo	*Course No*	*Course Title*	*Credits*	*Proposed by*
01	CHE686	Integrated Catalysis, Reaction and Reactor Engineering	3-0-0-0-9	Dr R G S Pala
02	CHE687	Quantum Mechanical Design of Engineering Materials and Industrial Catalysts	3-0-0-0-9	Dr R G S Pala

(b) Transferring of two zero credit courses of M Tech part to PhD part

S No	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Decision*
01	19106273	Harish Ranot	MSE	PhD	Programme was converted from M Tech to PhD; DPGC recommended.	Approved.

(c) Waiver of courses from minimum requirements of PhD programme

S No	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Decision*
01	18507265	Prabhakar K Pandey	CHM	PhD	Supervisor and DPGC recommended.	Approved waiver of two courses.

Item 4 Requiring SPGC Recommendations for Consideration of Chairperson Senate / Senate

(a) Inclusion of co-supervisor outside IIT Kanpur

S No	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Recommendation*

01	18205011	Ram Kishor Singh	ME	M Tech	Dr C P Paul, RRCAT Indore; Supervisor and DPGC recommended	Recommended
02	18205414	Vijay Kumar Saini	ME	MSR	Dr C P Paul, RRCAT Indore; Supervisor and DPGC recommended	Recommended
03	17105285	KokkondaVikas	ME	PhD	Dr A Bhateja, IIT Goa; Supervisor and DPGC recommended	Recommended
04	15103268	Jagajyoti Panda	CE	PhD	Dr S Chakraborty, IIT Palakad; Supervisor and DPGC recommended	Recommended
05	18103014	Amarjeet Tiwari	CE	M Tech	Dr M Barman, University of Minnesota, Duluth, USA	Recommended

(b) Exit from PhD programme with MS (By Research) degree

S No	*Roll No*	*Name*	*Dept*	*Prog*	*Remark*	*SPGC Recommendation*
01	17204278	Shivam Singh	EE	PhD	Supervisor and DPGC recommended	Recommends with MS (By Research) degree

5 Policy matters requiring detailed discussions.

(a) To consider 'soft copy only' submission of all theses.

The SPGC recommends the proposal to the Senate with the following consensus view of the SPGC (enclosed in appendix).

(b) To apprise SPGC of cases of ethical concerns raised during PhD theses review.

The SPGC took cognizance of ethical issues in PhD theses that have been recently pointed out by the external referees during the thesis review process. The SPGC felt that it would be appropriate to bring the matter to the knowledge of the Senate.

(c) Waiver for summer term registration of Part-Time category students.

The SPGC discussed waiver of summer term registration for Part-Time category students and recommends the following to the Senate

i. Waiver be granted upon an explicit request by the individual.

ii. The request should be duly recommended by the supervisor and DPGC.

(d) Requirement of submitting revised PhD thesis in light of referee comments.

The SPGC deliberated, requiring the student to submit a detailed point-by-point response to external referee comments on his/her submitted thesis. There is however no explicit requirement of submitting a revised thesis. The SPGC felt that no submission of the revised thesis tends to dilute the purpose for which the external thesis review procedure has been mandated by the Senate. It therefore strongly recommends that the submission of a soft copy of the revised thesis with referee specific changes highlighted in alternative colours, be made a mandatory requirement along with submission of the point by point response to referee comments.

(e) To take cognizance of data on Masters programme getting extended beyond the stipulated 22 months duration.

The SPGC constituted the sub-committee noted below to suggest the way forward.
1. I S Dalal CHE Convenor 2. Devpriya Kumar CGS Member 3. M Chaudhuri CSE Member

The committee shall do the needful and report back to the SPGC in a timely manner.

6 Any other item with the permission of the Chair.

(a) Waiver of six-month restriction of delivery of open seminar for additional M Tech/ M Des/MSR degree to PhD candidates in Engineering admitted directly after BS/B Tech/MSc.

SNo	Roll No	Name	Dept	Prog	Remark	SPGC Recommendation
01	14104269	Mahathi T Bhargavapuri	EE	PhD	M Tech defense over 13.6.19: Supervisor and DPGC recommended.	In view of the stated mitigating circumstances recommends with no objection to granting the waiver.

(b) PG students who did not register/seek academic extensions for the semester 2019-20-I

SNo	Roll No	Name	Dept	Prog	Remark	SPGC Recommendation
1	15103026	P Kharab	CE	MTech	Not sought academic extension	Recommends termination
2	17103087	S K Singh	CE	M Tech	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
3	18103077	S Kesarwani	CE	M Tech	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
4	17102037	V Dhillon	CHE	M Tech	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
5	16104093	T Thresia Cyriac	EE	M Tech	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
6	18104092	Ritesh Raj	EE	M Tech	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
7	17105092	M S Choudhary	ME	M Tech	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
8	17105139	S K Tiwari	ME	M Tech	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
9	16105415	P K Sahu	ME	MSR	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
10	17102266	Sulochana Nagar	CHE	PhD	Neither on leave nor registered	-do-
11	11111062	Gandhi T Nagardas	CSE	PhD	Not sought academic extension	-do-
12	14105266	Arun Agarwal	ME	PhD	Did not pay the fee	-do-
13	Y8101061	Assiz M P	AE	PhD	Not sought academic extension	-do-
14	Y9101064	K R Prashanth	AE	PhD	Not sought academic extension	-do-
15	13101068	Puja Sunil	AE	PhD	Not sought academic extension	-do-
16	13104189	Shirazul Islam	EE	PhD	Not sought academic extension	-do-
17	13106068	Sudha	MSE	PhD	Not sought academic extension	-do-

(c) Second time SOTA deadline extension

S No	Roll No	Name	Dept	Due date	First extension granted upto	Second extension request	SPGC Decision
01	15511262	G Siddiqui	CSE	07/06/19	07/09/19	07/12/19	Granted extension for upto07/12/2019

(d) Leave for the semesters 2019-20-I and II

S No	Roll No	Name	IDP	Prog	Remark	SPGC Decision
01	17128264	Shoukkathali K	CGS	PhD	Student has not yet appeared for comprehensive examination. Supervisor and DPGC recommended.	Granted leave for the semester 2019-20-I.

(e) Dropping of course below minimum (27 credits) required

S No	Roll No	Name	IDP	Prog	Remark	SPGC Decision
01	19111277	Yashika Verma	CSE	PhD	Instructor and DPGC are strongly recommended.	Granted permission on medical grounds. To be reported to the Senate

(Nitin Kaistha)
Chairperson, SPGC

Copy to: 1. All Members of SPGC
2. Chairman, Senate
3. DOAA

SPGC VIEW ON SUBMISSION OF ALL THESES IN SOFT COPY ONLY

Preamble

The entire world is moving towards paperless transactions. At IIT Kanpur, M Tech/M Des theses are being submitted in soft copy since 2017. With respect to PhD and MS(R) theses that are subjected to external review, the PG office still requires submission of, respectively, four and one bound hardcopies of the thesis to facilitate the external review process. PG office experience suggests that less than 10% of external reviewers request a hard-copy of the thesis. Several reviewers also email back a soft-copy of the thesis with annotated comments. This suggests that a very large majority of reviewers are happy to review the thesis provided in soft copy only.

Suggested Way Forward

Taking into account the ground realities above, the SPGC recommends that:

(a) All theses be submitted in soft copy only from now onwards.
(b) The external thesis reviewers be informed that a hard copy of the thesis shall be provided on request. Since the number of such requests is expected to be small, PG office shall take the responsibility of providing the hard copy to the external reviewer.

It is further clarified that the thesis supervisor shall remain responsible for arranging one hard copy of the final revised version of the thesis and the student response to review comments (if applicable) during the thesis oral defence for the benefit of the oral board members.